

Fundamentals of MIS (BA 3204)

Course Direction and Semester Plan

1. Course Information

Course Code	BA 3204
Course Title	Fundamentals of MIS
Course Type	Major
Credit Value	3.00
Contact Hours	3.0 hrs / week
Year and Semester	
Pre-requisite	N/A

2. Why This Course

Every organization today, large or small, runs on information systems: from point-of-sale terminals and mobile apps to enterprise-wide platforms that connect suppliers, employees, and customers. This course gives you the concepts, vocabulary, and management perspective needed to understand how businesses use information systems to run daily operations, make better decisions, and build a competitive edge. Regardless of your major, whether marketing, finance, accounting, or management, you will graduate into a workplace where evaluating, adopting, and working effectively with information systems is part of everyday managerial responsibility.

3. What You Will Learn (Course Learning Outcomes)

- Explain how information systems transform and support business operations in a global, digital economy.
- Describe how business processes, collaboration, and organizational structure shape and are shaped by information systems.
- Apply strategic models, such as Porter's competitive forces and value chain, to evaluate how firms use information systems for competitive advantage.
- Identify the ethical, social, and legal issues raised by the use of information technology, including privacy and intellectual property.
- Describe the components of IT infrastructure and assess emerging technology trends such as cloud computing, mobile platforms, and virtualization.
- Explain how organizations manage data resources through database systems and use business intelligence tools to support decision making.
- Describe how enterprise, supply chain, and customer relationship management systems help firms achieve operational excellence and customer intimacy.
- Outline the core activities and methodologies used to plan, design, and build information systems.

4. Weekly Course Plan

Each week combines lecture, real-world examples, and class discussion.

Week 1 Information Systems in Global Business Today

- Core concepts: data, information, information technology, information systems, and management information systems, and how these differ.
- How an information system functions through input, processing, output, and feedback.
- The three dimensions of an information system: organization, management, and technology.
- The six strategic business objectives of information systems: operational excellence, new products/services/business models, customer and supplier intimacy, improved decision making, competitive advantage, and survival.
- Technical and behavioral approaches used to study information systems.

Week 2 Global E-business and Collaboration

- What business processes are and how information technology improves them.
- How systems serve different management groups (TPS, MIS, DSS, ESS) and link the enterprise.
- E-business, e-commerce, and e-government.
- Collaboration, social business, and the role of the information systems function.

Week 3 Information Systems, Organizations, and Strategy

- Features of organizations that managers need to understand to build and use information systems.
- Economic, organizational, and behavioral impacts of information systems.
- Porter's competitive forces model, the value chain model, and network economics.
- Sustaining competitive advantage and aligning IT with business objectives.

Week 4 Ethical and Social Issues in Information Systems

- A framework for thinking about ethical, social, and political issues raised by information systems.
- Principles for guiding ethical decisions and professional codes of conduct.
- Privacy and intellectual property challenges in the internet age.
- Accountability, liability, system quality, and quality-of-life issues.

Week 5 IT Infrastructure and Emerging Technologies

- Definition, stages, and drivers of IT infrastructure evolution.
- Core components of IT infrastructure: hardware, software, data, and networking platforms.
- Current hardware and software trends: mobile platforms, cloud computing, and virtualization.
- Managing infrastructure change, governance, and technology investment decisions.

Week 6 Foundations of Business Intelligence: Databases and Information Management

- Problems of managing data in a traditional file environment.
- Capabilities of database management systems and the power of the relational model.
- Tools for accessing data for decision making: big data and business intelligence.
- Information policy, data administration, and data quality assurance.

Week 7 Achieving Operational Excellence and Customer Intimacy: Enterprise Applications

- Enterprise systems and their business value in achieving operational excellence.
- Supply chain management systems and coordination with suppliers.
- Customer relationship management systems and achieving customer intimacy.
- Challenges of enterprise applications and next-generation enterprise platforms.

Week 8 Building Information Systems

- How building new systems drives organizational change and business process redesign.
- Core activities in the systems development process: analysis, design, and implementation.
- Methodologies for modeling and designing systems, including structured and object-oriented approaches.
- Alternative approaches to building systems: traditional life cycle, prototyping, packages, and agile development.

5. How You Will Be Assessed

- Quizzes and class tests: short, periodic checks through the semester.
- Assignments: case studies or problems, submitted by the due date/Presentations: group or individual, on assigned topics or cases.

Marks Distribution

Component	Weight
Class Tests	10%
Assignments/Presentation	10%
Attendance	10%
Mid-Semester Examination	30%
End-Semester Examination	40%
Total	100%

6. Learning Materials

Textbook

- Kenneth C. Laudon and Jane P. Laudon: “Management Information Systems Managing the Digital Firm, 15th Edition, Pearson Publications